



IDS11074

Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia Gulf Waters

Issued at 3:30 pm CST on Tuesday 18 August 2026
for the period until midnight CST Friday 21 August 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A cold front moving through the Bight, directs a northerly flow over South Australia this evening. The front will clip the south on Wednesday, before clearing to the east late. A high pressure ridge is expected to approach South Australia on Thursday from the west and continue to move east over the state on the weekend. Weak troughs clip the southeast in a broad westerly flow on Thursday and Friday.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending north to northwesterly in the evening. Winds reaching up to 25 knots near the Yorke Peninsula coast in the late evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Port Neill to Port Victoria. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm south of Cowell to Wallaroo later this evening.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning westerly 10 to 15 knots in the middle of the day. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres around midday, then decreasing to around 1 metre during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: Northwesterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable about 10 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Port Neill to Port Victoria. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: West to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots decreasing to about 10 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly about 10 knots increasing to 15 to 20 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm later tonight.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots turning westerly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre by early evening. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: Northwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning westerly below 10 knots during the afternoon and evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: West to southwesterly about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Central Coast

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Strong Wind Warning for Tuesday for Central Coast

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 25 knots turning northwesterly 20 to 25 knots in the evening. Winds reaching up to 30 knots in the west in the evening. Seas: 1 to 2 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm later this evening.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Strong Wind Warning for Wednesday for Central Coast

Winds: Northwesterly 20 to 25 knots turning westerly 15 to 25 knots early in the morning. Winds reaching up to 30 knots in the west in the late morning. Seas: 1.5 to 2.5 metres, decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres, tending westerly 2.5 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: West to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots tending west to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres around midday, then decreasing below 1 metre by early evening. Swell: Westerly 2.5 to 3 metres, tending southwesterly 3 metres by early evening. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: West to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 3 metres during the evening. Weather: Cloudy.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending northerly 15 to 25 knots in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres later in the evening. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm later this evening.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots tending west to northwesterly 15 to 25 knots early in the morning. Seas: 1 to 2 metres. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning, then tending westerly 1.5 to 2.5 metres around midday. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm through the Backstairs Passage in the early morning.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: West to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots tending west to southwesterly below 10 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Westerly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: Westerly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 pm CST Tuesday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.